

```
For .zip
$> unzip <filename>
```

All the three above methods will extract the content of the package into the current directory. So ensure you are in the directory where you want to dump the source code. Kindly note, this has nothing to do with the installation directory that will be decided automatically by the installer.

A good practice would be to create a directory to put all your source code in, the recommended place is to use `/usr/local/src`, you should ensure that you have write privileges for that directory, this can also be done by the following

```
$ sudo chown your_user_name /usr/local/src
$ sudo chmod u+rwx /usr/local/src
```

As you might have guessed, you can replace `/usr/local/src` with whatever directory you wish, but the default is the recommended way.

You can also use the graphical way, if you have the option of, just using an archive utility and extracting them into a location of your choice

Moving to the second method of obtaining the source code, or the version control way. There are four popular revision controls used for open-source software

- SVN
- GIT
- CVS
- Mercurial

The commands above have already installed the required tools for using them, on the project page there would be an explicit command for their respective version control, in our htop example it is:

```
$ svn co https://htop.svn.sourceforge.net/svnroot/htop/
trunk htop
```

Once you have obtained the package it is always a good idea to look for a `ReadMe.txt` or a `install.txt`, which will typically contain helpful instructions towards compiling and installing the software on your machine. They may also inform you about any special requirements that are there, if any.

Now depending on how the file is packaged you may have multiple options, the most common option is to look for a `configure` file in the contents of the source code you have just downloaded. If present, then open a terminal, switch to the directory where you have extracted the source code, and type in

```
$ ./configure.
```